



Facebook announces Oculus Go

The headset, priced at \$199, won't require plugging in a smartphone or a cord tethering it to a personal computer. <http://dgit.in/OculusGo>



Qualcomm modem in Watch 3

ABI Research's Teardown just uncovered that Apple is using a Qualcomm modem in the Apple Watch 3. <http://dgit.in/aplqual>

Apple iPhone 8 Plus

Has the substance but lacks the style

Apple's upgraded iPhones in the form of iPhone 8 and iPhone 8 Plus have been launched under the shadow of the real hero from the Apple stable, the iPhone X. With the iPhone X in the mix (or rather the center), the iPhone 8 series almost comes across as a second choice for the prospective iPhone buyer, only to be considered if you can't make it to the iPhone X.

So, how good is the iPhone 8 Plus, and do does it give you enough reasons to bring it in your consideration set? Let's find out.

Build and design

Overall, on the looks, design and build front, the iPhone 8 Plus comes across as a well-built phone, feels super premium in terms of fit and finish, but it struggles to excite or wow you. For a smartphone with a 5.5-inch display; it's weight, dimensions and design are clearly a few generations behind and they don't match-up to the current crop of flagships. The fact that it almost looks the same as a 3 year old iPhone does not help its cause at all.

The display

With a 5.5-inch 1080p display, the iPhone 8 Plus surely won't win any points on pixel density. However, where it surely comes out on top is the accuracy, white balance and usability front. The 5.5-inch IPS display is adequately sharp and offers accurate colors. The True Tone display, which was first seen on the 9.7-inch iPad Pro, makes its way into the iPhone 8 series as well. True Tone technology on the iPhone 8 Plus dynamically adjusts the color temperature to match the ambient light condition, a bid to produce accurate colours irrespective of the light conditions. Overall, the



FEATURES.....	81
PERFORMANCE.....	94
VALUE.....	70
DESIGN.....	72

True Tone feature does make a difference and is particularly handy in brightly lit (outdoor) environments. However, activating True Tone feature slightly shifts the overall colour tone towards the warmer side.

Performance

Let alone synthetic benchmarks (where it easily beats every other flagship smartphones), even when it comes to heavy multitasking environments with extended periods of usage, the iPhone 8 Plus shows no sign of any lag or slowing down. The fast hardware goes brilliantly well with the optimised OS, we never faced any issues in terms of apps freezing or crashes. In that sense, the iPhone 8 Plus is supremely dependable, it just works, and you can count on it. The hexa core A11 Bionic chip at the heart of the iPhone 8 plus runs at 2.17 GHz (at peak) and has a massive 8MB of L2 cache, a substantial change (improvement) in comparison to the A10 and A9 SoCs used in previous generation iPhones, which came with 3MB L2 cache + 4MB L3 cache configuration.

Camera

The iPhone 8 Plus has evidently improved in the image quality department over the previous generation. In day light, the iPhone 8 Plus produced excellent image quality with accurate colors and well-preserved details. The iPhone 8 Plus locks focus instantly and offers blazing fast capture speeds. We also noticed improvements in detail levels, colors and sharpness when using the telephoto lens. When it comes to low-light, the iPhone 8 Plus doesn't show the same level of improvements and it does fall behind the competition. The portrait lighting mode (in beta state) is a nice (new) feature that uses depth mapping to bring studio lighting effects to portraits. The feature is a nice touch and offers opportunities to experiment with portrait photography. You can even alter the lighting after the portrait is clicked. The fact that the feature is in "beta" mode does show, we weren't able to consistently get accurate separation when using the lighting effects.

Battery life

With a slightly smaller capacity battery slice in comparison to the iPhone 7 Plus, a faster SoC and perhaps even a more power-hungry screen, the odds were against the iPhone 8 Plus to improve upon or deliver stellar battery life. However, we were pleasantly surprised at how the iPhone 8 Plus easily went past a busy day with the battery meter showing 15% of life before we put it to charge. Heavy users can also expect the iPhone 8 Plus to last them the day on a full charge. Which is pretty good in our books for such a high-performance smartphone.

Read our full in-depth review here: <http://dgit.in/appl8pl>

—Soham Raninga

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: A11 Bionic | RAM: 3GB | OS: iOS 11 | STORAGE: 256GB | BATTERY: 2691 mAh | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS | SIZE: 5.5-inches | RESOLUTION: 1080p | CAMERA PRIMARY: Dual 12MP camera (wide + telephoto), 4K video capture at 60 FPS.

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